STATE SCAN

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BANDRA OF ANDHRA
What the Amaravati 2.0 skyline may look like, in an artist's rendering

▶ ANDHRA PRADESH

REBIRTH OF THE DREAM CAPITAL

It will cost over Rs 45,000 cr. in the first phase, but Naidu's Amaravati is back on track, aiming to be one of the world's 'five best cities'

By **Amarnath K. Menon**

A FIVE-YEAR HIATUS IS NOTHING WHEN seen against the span of history. On May 2, Andhra Pradesh chief minister N. Chandrababu Naidu's dream capital Amaravati renews its tryst with destiny, returning from the realm of imagination to that of brick and mortar. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who laid its foundation stone at Uddandarayunipalem on October 22, 2015, is again at hand as the greenfield capital goes into construction.

There's plenty on the drawing board. Naidu, chairing a huddle of the Capital Region Development Authority (CRDA) in March, sanctioned work for 59 development projects at a total cost of Rs 37,702 crore. Amaravati 2.0, visualised as "a smart city with state-of-the-art amenities, efficient transportation systems and green spaces", will see Rs 64,721 crore invested in its first phase, which has a completion timeline of 30 months. In its final shape, with nine theme cities and 27 townships spread over 217 square kilometres, Amaravati is projected as a job-creating economic hub and tourist attraction.

Await a modern assembly, a 250-metre-tall structure, with 1.12 million square footage, on a 103-acre compound whose upper tiers will be open to tourists when not in session. Also, a 47-storey Chief Minister's Office, spanning 1.7 million square feet, which will